Democratic Republic of Congo, Madagascar, China, India, Malaysia, Indonesia and Australia in which these centres are located.

11. *Abraham Ortelius,* a Dutch map maker, first proposed such a possibility as early as 1596. *Antonio Pellegrini* drew a map showing the three continents together.

    However, it was *Alfred Wegener*—a German meteorologist who put forth a comprehensive argument in the form of "the continental drift theory" in 1912. This was regarding the distribution of the oceans and the continents.

12. The strips of normal and reverse magnetic field that parallel the mid-oceanic ridges help scientists determine the rates of plate movement. These rates vary considerably. The Arctic Ridge has the slowest rate (less than 2.5 cm/yr), and the East Pacific Rise near Easter Island, in the South Pacific about 3,400 km west of Chile, has the fastest rate (more than 15 cm/yr).
13. Petrology is science of rocks. A petrologist studies rocks in all their aspects vis., mineral composition, texture, structure, origin, occurrence, alteration and relationship with other rocks.
14. Igneous rocks are classified based on texture. Texture depends upon size and arrangement of grains or other physical conditions of the materials. If molten material is cooled slowly at great depths, mineral grains may be very large. Sudden cooling (at the surface) results in small and smooth grains. Intermediate conditions of cooling would result in intermediate sizes of grains making up igneous rocks. Granite, gabbro, pegmatite, basalt, volcanic breccia and tuff are some of the examples of igneous rocks.
15. *Exfoliation is the peeling away of sheets of rock.*
    It is a result but not a process. Flaking off of more or less curved sheets of shells from over rocks or bedrock results in smooth and rounded surfaces Exfoliation can occur due to expansion and contraction induced by temperature changes. Exfoliation domes and tors result due to unloading and thermal expansion respectively.
16. The sun traverses 150 of longitudes per hour or one degree of longitude in every four minutes of time. It may further be noted